increasing U.S. aggression, and on the other, by the need for capable and experienced cadres to develop and run its institutions, drew closer to the country's old Communist Party, the PSP. Paradoxically, the PSP was one of the most conservative forces in the revolutionary coalition. Historic Party members tended to hold a hard line and a narrow view of what revolution could mean and could encompass. They scorned intellectual and cultural experimentation.

The Revolution's policies towards intellectual freedom were summarized by Fidel Castro in 1961 in an oft-quoted speech entitled "Words to Intellectuals." "Within the Revolution, everything; against the Revolution, nothing," he said. That is, a distinction is made between intellectual work, from art to literature to academics, which *opposes* the Revolution, and work which does not oppose it – and work which opposes the Revolution is not permitted. (This is essentially the same distinction enshrined in the Cuban Constitution: "freedom of speech" may not be exercised against the Constitution, the laws of the country, or socialism.)

This position, however, leaves much room for interpretation, and in fact the boundaries of what is considered "within the Revolution" and what is "against the Revolution" have changed considerably over time. American journalist Lee Lockwood, who spent several months traveling on the island and studying the Revolution in 1965 and 1966, was impressed that "under the loosely administered patronage of the Revolution, the arts have flourished in Cuba and remained refreshingly free of the ideological influence and restraint common to other socialist cultures."[31] In the 1970s the limits shrank considerably, and many intellectuals and ideas that had up until then been encompassed "within the Revolution" suddenly became defined as "against the Revolution" as the government became more closely aligned with the Soviet Union. Cuban intellectuals now refer to the five-year period between 1971 and 1976 as the "gray five years" because of the intense Sovietization of cultural life. "Socialist realism" as imposed during that period, explained Cuban author Ambrosio Fornet later, required a "literature as pedagogy and hagiography, aimed at developing 'positive heroes' erasing any possible conflicts in the 'bosom of the working class'."[32]